Revised 2026

CUHK (SZ)
Course Outline

1. Course Identity

A. Course as listed in CUHK (SZ)

The information in this block should be exactly as approved by CUHK Senate. In case there are any differences, please explain in the table below.

Course code	GED 3402
Course title (English)	Music in Western Civilization
Course title (Chinese)	西方文明中的音樂
Units	3
Language of Instruction	English
Description (English)	A survey of western classical music
Description (Chinese)	西洋古典音樂概覽

B. Corresponding course in CUHK

Please give details of the *closest* corresponding course in CUHK (as approved by CUHK Senate and listed in course list). If the course in SZ maps to more than one course in CUHK, please make multiple copies of the block below.

Course code	UGED 2080
Course title (English)	The Appreciation of Western Classical Music
Course title (Chinese)	西洋古典音樂欣賞
Units	2
Description (English)	
Description (Chinese)	

2. Prerequisites / Co-requisites

Please state prerequisites and co-requisites, in terms of courses in CUHK (SZ)* or any other requirements (e.g., having taken certain subjects in high school).

(* Because course codes may not yet be stable, please provide both course code and course tile.)

A. Prerequisites

B.

GFH1000/GFN1000

C. Co-requisites

GFH1000/GFN1000

3. Learning Outcomes

At the completion of the course, students should have been able to:

A. Formulate an overall view of the development of western music from the Medieval Period to the present day;
B. Differentiate the music from the various style periods in western music history;
C. Describe the particular musical genres and their overall structure;
D. Critically review the technical and stylistic features of a concert performance or recording;
E. Discuss the music aesthetics of different style periods.

4. Course syllabus

This course teaches students how to listen to music intelligently and make informed judgment on the musical style, the historical background and influences.

The course will start with the Greek doctrine of ethos in music leading into the periods of the Medieval and the Renaissance. It continues with the various style periods of the Baroque, Classical and Romantic where the solid foundation of western classical music was firmly established. The masterpieces written by Bach, Handel, Haydn, Mozart, Beethoven, Schubert, Schumann, Brahms, etc will be introduced and discussed as relating to their socio-cultural background. Moving into the diversified 20th century, different styles such as Nationalism, Impressionism, Expressionism, Minimalism, Abstract Art and pop culture in the western world will also be discussed.

5. Assessment Scheme

Component/ method	**% weight**
Attendance and participation	20
Listening Report (1,500)	40
Final Paper (1,500 words)	**40**
****The Listening Report and the Final Paper can be submitted at the end of the term.**	

6. Grade descriptor (please kindly find the samples of grade descriptor in the attachment below)

A Range (A, A-)	Very well organized and structured demonstrating a deep understanding and highly convincing interpretation with critical analysis of the subject/topic.
B Range (B+, B, B-)	Well organized and fluently written demonstrating a good level of understanding and analysis of the subject/topic.

C Range (C+, C, C-)	Recognizable organization showing a fair grasp of factual understanding yet with limited theoretical perspectives.
D Range (D+, D)	Very loosely organized and weak grammar demonstrating an inadequate understanding of the subject/topic.
F	Poorly organized with grammatical errors showing a poor understanding of the subject/topic

7. Feedback for evaluation

8. Reading

A. Required

B.

Nil

C. Recommended

1. Sadie, Stanley & Latham, Alison : *The Cambridge Music Guide*. Cambridge University Press. Paperback, NY. 2000

2. Bonds, Mark Evan : *A History of Music in Western Culture*. Prentice Hall, NY. 2005

3. Lang, Paul Henry : Music in Western Civilization. Norton, NY. First Thus Edition 1997

4. Hanning, Barbara Rusanna : *Concise History of Western Music*. Norton, NY. 2010

9. Course components

Activity	**Hours/week**
Lecture	3
Tutorial	Nil

10. Indicative teaching plan

Week	**Content/ topic/ activity**
1	The Rudiment of Music & Guidelines of Listening
2	The Function of Music in the Greek and Roman Empires: The Doctrine of Ethos
3	The Medieval Chant and Monophony
4	The Age of the Renaissance : Art, Architecture and Polyphony
5	The Baroque Period: Art, Architecture and Music
6	The Culmination of Music in the Baroque Era : Handel & Bach
7	The Age of the Enlightenment : Haydn & Mozart

8	Beethoven & His Nine Symphonies
9	German Romanticism in Literature & Music : Lieder
10	Italian and German Opera in Romantic Era : Verdi, Puccini & Wagner
11	Symphonic Works & Romanticism : Richard Strauss & Mahler
12	The French Impressionism in Art & Music
13	Twentieth Century Avant-garde Music
14	Pop Culture in the Western World

11. Implementation plan

The implementation plan may vary from year to year. Please indicate expected enrolment, and number of sections.

Expected enrolment: up to around 100

Mainly lectures with listening excerpts, no tutorials.

12. Approval (for School Use only)

Has the course title been included in the programme submission approved by CUHK Senate? Are there any differences?
Submitted and approved in 2020.

Have the details (as in this document) been approved at School or other level in CUHK (SZ)?

13. Academic Honesty

Attention is drawn to University policy and regulations on honesty in academic work, and to the disciplinary guidelines and procedures applicable to breaches of such policy and regulations. Details may be found at

https://registry.cuhk.edu.cn/en/page/30

With each assignment, students will be required to submit a signed declaration that they are aware of these policies, regulations, guidelines and procedures. For group projects, all students of the same group should be asked to sign on the declaration.

[Teachers could add more detailed instruction/requirement regarding academic honesty].

14. Any other information

None

15. Version date

Version number	003
As of (date)	20210816

Attachment

1. Course grades, their standard and converted GPA points:

Grade and Standard		*Sub-divisions (if needed)*	*Converted Points*
A	Excellent	A	4
A-	Very good	A-	3.7
B	Good	B+	3.3
		B	3
		B-	2.7
C	Fair	C+	2.3
		C	2
		C-	1.7
D	Pass	D+	1.3
		D	1
F	Failure	F	0
P	Ungraded pass	Counted towards the total number of units gained by a student but not counted in the calculation of the GPA	
U	Failure (unsatisfactory performance)		

2. Samples of Grade Descriptors

a. Sample One

Grade	**Overall course**
A	Outstanding performance on all learning outcomes, including learning attitude, profound understanding of the theories and methods involved in investigated translation and other related issues.
A-	Generally outstanding performance on all (or almost all) learning outcomes, demonstrating good learning attitude and performance and good understanding of the different aspects involved in accomplishing outstanding performance in class participation and in completing

	assignments.
B	Substantial performance on all learning outcomes, OR high performance on some learning outcomes which compensates for less satisfactory performance on others, resulting in overall substantial performance.
C	Satisfactory performance on the majority of learning outcomes, possibly with a few weaknesses.
D	Barely satisfactory performance on a number of learning outcomes.
F	Unsatisfactory performance on a number of learning outcomes, OR failure to meet specified assessment requirements.

b. Sample Two

A	Demonstrating outstanding understanding and grasp of the basic concepts introduced in class and the readings, and capable of applying them with accuracy and clarity when handling new tasks independently
A-	Demonstrating excellent understanding and grasp of the basic concepts introduced in class, and generally capable of applying them when handling new tasks independently.
B+	Demonstrating very good understanding and grasp of the basic concepts introduced in class, and able to refer to them when handling new tasks
B	Demonstrating good understanding and grasp of the basic concepts introduced in class, and able to link them when handling new tasks
B-	Demonstrating fairly good understanding and grasp of the basic concepts introduced in class, and able to handle new tasks
C+	Demonstrating some knowledge and understanding of the basic concepts introduced in class; performance generally satisfactory when handling new tasks
C	Demonstrating limited knowledge and some understanding of the basic concepts introduced in class, with some lapses when handling new tasks
C-	Demonstrating little knowledge and understanding of the basic concepts introduced in class, with significant lapses in accuracy and clarity when handling new tasks
D	Demonstrating superficial knowledge and understanding of the basic concepts introduced in class, with wide spread lapses in accuracy and clarity when handling new tasks

c. Sample Three (the course was taught in Putonghua)

Grade A: 能按要求准时提交各期临摹作品；作品符合相应的技法规范，并能积极深入探索花鸟画表现技法；积极参与课堂讨论且无缺勤记录。

Grade A-:能按要求准时提交各期临摹作品；作品符合相应的技法规范，并能初步探索花鸟画表现技法；积极参与课堂讨论且无缺勤记录。

B Range：能按要求准时提交各期临摹作品；作品符合相应的技法规范；积极参与课堂讨论且无缺勤记录。

C Range：能按要求准时提交各期临摹作品；作品符合相应的技法规范；偶尔参与课堂讨论；有缺勤记录。

D Range：能按时提交各期临摹作品；作品基本符合技法规范，但比较模糊；极少参与课堂讨论，有多次缺勤记录。

F：不能按时提交各期临摹作品；作品不符合技法规范、作品显示作者明显缺乏对所学